

Higher Education- New pillars of learning in the desert



Few years ago, a student from Rajasthan wanting to pursue higher, technical or vocational education had to either travel down to Metros or overseas. But in recent years things have started to change as Rajasthan, the land of forts and palaces, famous as a tourist destination is now fast emerging as an educational hub.

Today the state is attracting students from different parts of country. It is nothing less than a paradigm shift where the trends have changed from students migrating from Rajasthan to students coming to Rajasthan. Gunjan Chandra, B.E. final year student who has come to study here from Delhi says, "Rajasthan not only offers peaceful environment, it also now offers various innovative courses in different fields. Moreover, with good companies coming up, future prospects look bright to me in Rajasthan than anywhere else". Echoing similar views, Anshuman Singh, B.E 3rd semester resident of Bihar says, "Good environment and placement opportunities were the main reason behind my decision to come and study here. The education system is better here and moreover with number of institutes, students like me have ample choices to choose from".

Shedding image of its lagging behind in the field of education, Rajasthan has now a sound infrastructure of education. The state has recorded one

of the highest percentage increase in literacy rate among Indian states in the last decade. Its literacy rate in 2001 has jumped to 61.03 percent from 38.55 in 1991.

Thanks to Vasundhara Raje government's pragmatic policies, the state is being flooded with offers for investment in education sector. The State has witnessed a fresh investment of Rs. 4500 Crore in Private Education Sector and Rs. 3500 Crore in the Government Sector, of which Rs. 1000 Crore private investment is only in Technical Education, because of which many of the corporate are finding Rajasthan alluring and are keen to invest in state.

Many leading institutes have already been set up in the state while others are on the verge of doing so. The Government of Rajasthan has already allotted 100 acres of land near Jaipur to Manipal Education and Medical Group, first deemed University with an ISO 9001 : 2000 certification, for setting up its 'Off Campus Centre' in Jaipur that would include Engineering College, School of Management, School for Hotel and Hospitality Management, Biotechnology and allied Health Science, Medical College, Nursing and additional Allied Health Programmes etc, in a phased manner, with an estimated investment of Rs. 300 Crore. The academic session is due to start in 2009.

Similarly Gomber Education Foundation is also establishing the



Singapore Raffles International an investment of Rs 150 crore. The education leader is also coming from Jaipur. The project would be global in its operation and will be a state government for this project.

In a major fillip to Higher Education, the Government of Rajasthan has announced the establishment of National University, Jaipur, Manipal University, Jaipur, Sir Padampat Singhania University, Jaipur, Panchajanya University, Jaipur, Jyoti Vihar University, Jaipur, Jodhpur University, Jaipur, etc. to become functional.

To improve the quality and delivery of education, the Government of Rajasthan has announced the setting up of Private Universities. The first meeting was held in November 07 in Jaipur. Significant progress has been made in this regard. The state has witnessed the establishment of Private Education System and the number of colleges has increased from 285 with capacity having 30,500 in 2003 - 04 respectively to 391 in 2008. Colleges in comparison to 391 in 2003 - 04, 431 in the Polytechnic and 431 in comparison of 23 in 2003 - 04.

The state Government is committed to the development of Technical Education in the State. Of the 22 investment agreements signed at the Partnership Summit work is in progress. Society, Dungarpur, Gyan Raipur, Jaipur, Jyoti Rao Phoolke Shikshan Samiti, Nagaur. Private Colleges being set up at Dholpur, Bundi and Jalore.

The state is one of the leading states in partnership in education. The